Persuaded by political strategists, several sections of the media worked in overdrive to lash out at the government and brand it as anti-farmer. A sympathy wave was carefully crafted for the Rahul Gandhi-led opposition parties by positioning them as sensitive and pro-farmer leaders. The problem with this strategy was that Rahul has been visible mostly on social media platforms. In no way does his persona seem like someone who'd be at natural ease amidst groups of commoners. On the contrary, he comes across as a dynast, who prefers to be surrounded by others like him—only to step out of that group for political photo-opportunities and media interactions. It is my firm and humble belief that keeping him hidden from public view at most times is a deliberate strategy—after all, he is gaff-prone and tends to fumble while speaking. So, keeping him somewhat sheltered is the best tactic that his political pundits can adopt. Adding to his woes are his sympathizers in the party and media who overcompensate and go rather overboard. His party's spokespersons also come across as loose cannons. Thus, for the prime minister and his party, it makes most sense to just stand back; let all the world's camera lenses focus on Gandhi's light-and-sound show. Many top forlorn and despondent leaders from the Congress and other opposition parties see eye-to-eye about the politically comfortable position that the prime minister usually finds himself in due to lack of Gandhi's credibility; that there is no need to eliminate someone who is already in self-destruct mode. Gandhi truly is BJP's greatest asset, they say.[20]

After the ebbing of the first wave, the central government had begun to give more autonomy to the states and UTs to use guidelines developed by the GoI during the first wave and implement them in their respective regions to the best of their wisdom. So naturally, with the Delhi government lay the jurisdiction of controlling crowds at the protest sites. However, they chose to turn a blind eye despite a surge in COVID-19 cases and harp on the back of the popular anti-establishment media narrative that was taking shape. It was all too spicy an opportunity for them to let go of. Neither did they attempt to dismiss the crowds, nor did they carry out a respectable number of tests at protest sites. They didn't bother to put in a mandatory quarantine rule for rolling protestors either. Despite assurance from the central government that the farmers' demands would be taken care of followed by intervention by the Supreme Court, the farmers refused to budge unless the laws were repealed—no negotiation, no dialogue. In this